

ROMAS Brief: Design Intelligence Report

A Competitive Analysis of The Imaging Wire + Comprehensive Design Proposal for ROMAS Brief

Prepared by Manus AI | May 28, 2026

Part I: The Imaging Wire — Homepage Analysis

What The Imaging Wire Is

The Imaging Wire is a B2B medical newsletter and news publication targeting radiologists, imaging executives, and medical technology professionals. Its homepage at theimagingwire.com serves as both a content archive and a subscriber acquisition funnel.

Homepage Structure (As Observed)

The homepage is organized into the following sequential zones, from top to bottom:

Zone	Content	Visual Treatment
Global Header	Logo (left), nav links (Top Stories, Newsletters, Shows, Sponsor), Subscribe CTA	Flat white bar, minimal styling
Hero / Subscription Block	Tagline (“Healthcare can be complicated. Your radiology news shouldn’t be.”), email form	Full-width, solid cyan-blue background (#00a0d2), white text
Featured Issue Banner	Latest newsletter issue number and title	Large image (left), issue metadata + title (right)
Top 4 Stories Grid	4 articles in a 1+3 layout (1 large left, 3 stacked right)	Image thumbnails, category kicker, date, bold headline
Sponsor Banner	Full-width display ad (e.g., DeepHealth, Bayer)	Standard IAB leaderboard format
“More Stories” Feed	Chronological list of all articles	Alternating 3-column grid and full-width list rows
Compact Story Grid	4-column grid of older articles	Smaller thumbnails, title only
Bottom Conversion Block	Second email signup form	Flat, minimal design
Footer	Navigation links, sister publications (Digital Health Wire, Cardiac Wire), social links	Standard footer

The page is entirely **light-mode**, uses a **white background** with a **cyan-blue (#00a0d2) accent**, and relies on **generic sans-serif typography** throughout. A **modal pop-up** (“Like the website? You’ll love the newsletter”) fires on scroll, interrupting the reading experience.

Part II: Three Expert Critiques

Expert 1 — The UX/UI Architect

Verdict: Functional but fatiguing. No visual hierarchy beyond the hero.

The Imaging Wire's most significant UX failure is the absence of differentiated visual weight across the article feed. From the fifth article onward, every card is rendered identically: a left-aligned 300×200 thumbnail, a category kicker in small caps, a date, a bold headline, and a two-sentence excerpt. This “infinite scroll of sameness” provides no cognitive cues to guide the reader's eye toward what is most important, most recent, or most relevant to their specialty.

The above-the-fold experience is dominated by a solid cyan subscription block that occupies roughly 35% of the initial viewport on a standard 1440px desktop monitor. While subscriber acquisition is a legitimate business priority, this placement is aggressive and pushes actual editorial content below the fold for first-time visitors who have not yet established trust with the brand. The navigation is also problematic: the five nav links float in a flat white bar with no visual anchor, no active-state indicators, and no sub-navigation to help users find topic-specific content.

The mobile experience is likely to suffer from the rigid, full-width horizontal band structure. The 4-column compact grid near the bottom of the page, in particular, will collapse poorly on screens below 768px. There is no evidence of a mobile-first design philosophy.

Key Recommendations: Implement a sticky, structured header with clear sub-navigation. Introduce at least three distinct article card variants (Feature, Standard, Quick Hit) to create visual rhythm. Eliminate the full-width subscription banner from above the fold and replace it with an integrated, inline conversion strategy.

Expert 2 — The Editorial Strategist

Verdict: Reads like an RSS feed, not a curated publication.

A premium B2B medical publication earns its authority through editorial curation — the act of telling the reader “this is what matters today and why.” The Imaging Wire's homepage, despite its high-quality content, fails to communicate this curation. The page is organized strictly by reverse chronology, which means the editorial team's judgment about importance is invisible to the reader.

There is no distinction between a breaking regulatory news item, a deep-dive clinical analysis, a sponsored thought-leadership piece, and a quick industry brief. All four are presented with the same template, the same visual weight, and the same amount of space. This flattening of editorial hierarchy is a significant missed opportunity. A reader who is a radiation oncologist interested specifically in AI-assisted treatment planning has to

scroll through articles about MR scanner safety and radiologist salaries to find relevant content. There are no “Topic Cluster” modules, no “Trending in AI” sidebars, and no personalization signals.

The site also lacks a clear “voice” or editorial personality. The tagline (“Healthcare can be complicated. Your radiology news shouldn’t be.”) is effective and memorable, but this personality does not extend into the page design. The homepage feels transactional — a list of links — rather than authoritative — a curated briefing.

Key Recommendations: Introduce topic-cluster modules on the homepage that group articles by specialty area. Create a “Today’s Top Story” or “Editor’s Pick” designation with distinct visual treatment. Develop a “Quick Hits” module for short-form news items, visually separated from long-form analysis. Add a “Trending This Week” sidebar to surface high-engagement content.

Expert 3 — The Brand & Conversion Specialist

Verdict: The brand underperforms its audience’s expectations; the conversion strategy is blunt-force.

The Imaging Wire’s audience — radiologists, imaging center directors, and medical technology executives — is among the most highly educated and highly compensated professional cohorts in healthcare. This audience has been conditioned by premium media brands (The Economist, STAT News, NEJM) to expect a visual language that projects authority, precision, and sophistication. The current design does not meet this expectation.

The cyan-blue (#00a0d2) and white color scheme is more reminiscent of a generic hospital IT portal or a mid-2010s SaaS landing page than a premium clinical intelligence publication. The typography is competent but generic, lacking the character that would distinguish the brand in a crowded inbox. There is no use of data visualization, infographics, or other visual elements that would reinforce the “intelligence” positioning of the brand.

The conversion strategy is the most significant commercial weakness. The site deploys three separate email capture mechanisms: a full-width hero banner, a scroll-triggered modal pop-up, and a bottom-of-page form. This “spray and pray” approach signals desperation rather than confidence in the editorial product. Modern B2B media brands that command premium CPMs (like Morning Brew or STAT News) integrate conversion

seamlessly into the content experience — through gated premium content, inline “Read the full analysis” prompts, and elegant sticky footers — rather than interrupting it.

Key Recommendations: Redesign the brand palette toward a more sophisticated, high-contrast system (deep navy/slate + a precise accent color). Invest in custom typography that signals authority. Replace the modal pop-up with an elegant sticky footer conversion bar. Introduce a “premium tier” gating strategy to create perceived scarcity and drive higher-intent subscriptions.

Part III: Synthesized Upgrade Concept — “Clinical Intelligence Dashboard”

Drawing on all three expert critiques, the upgraded design concept for a publication like The Imaging Wire (and directly applicable to ROMAS Brief) centers on a single organizing principle: **the website should feel like an interactive, expanded version of the daily briefing email, not a blog archive.**

The key shifts are:

From chronological feed → to curated editorial modules. The homepage is restructured into distinct, named modules (The Daily Brief, Topic Clusters, Audio Intelligence, Deep Dives) that each serve a specific reader intent.

From flat visual hierarchy → to three-tier article card system. A “Feature Card” (full-width, large image, prominent excerpt) for the top 1-2 stories; a “Standard Card” (thumbnail + title + excerpt) for mid-tier stories; and a “Quick Hit” (title + timestamp only) for rapid-scan briefs.

From aggressive interruption → to integrated conversion. The subscription CTA is woven into the content flow at natural pause points, with compelling, audience-specific microcopy. The modal pop-up is eliminated entirely.

From generic aesthetics → to premium clinical brand. Deep navy/slate palette, authoritative typography, and a dark-mode option for technical readers.

Part IV: Comprehensive Design Proposal for ROMAS Brief

4.1 Strategic Positioning

ROMAS Brief occupies a more specialized niche than The Imaging Wire: it serves **radiation oncology physicists** specifically, with a multi-region, multi-edition, and audio-first value proposition. This specialization is a significant competitive advantage and must be expressed visually and architecturally at every touchpoint.

***Design Principle:** Every page of ROMAS Brief should communicate “this was built for you” to a radiation oncology physicist. The design language should feel as precise and evidence-based as the science it covers.*

4.2 Design System

Color Palette

Token	Value	Usage
<code>--color-primary-900</code>	<code>#0F172A</code> (Deep Slate)	Primary text, headers, nav background
<code>--color-primary-700</code>	<code>#1E3A5F</code> (Deep Navy)	Section headers, card backgrounds (dark)
<code>--color-accent-500</code>	<code>#0EA5E9</code> (Clinical Sky)	Interactive elements, links, CTA buttons
<code>--color-signal-green</code>	<code>#10B981</code>	Positive signal scores, “Practice Delta” labels
<code>--color-signal-amber</code>	<code>#F59E0B</code>	Moderate signal scores, “Regulatory” labels
<code>--color-signal-red</code>	<code>#EF4444</code>	High-urgency alerts, “FDA Brief” labels
<code>--color-surface-0</code>	<code>#FFFFFF</code>	Main content backgrounds
<code>--color-surface-50</code>	<code>#F8FAFC</code>	Secondary module backgrounds
<code>--color-surface-100</code>	<code>#F1F5F9</code>	Card hover states, sidebar backgrounds
<code>--color-border</code>	<code>#E2E8F0</code>	Dividers, card borders

The dark mode inverts the surface tokens and uses `--color-primary-900` as the base background, with `--color-surface-0` becoming `#1E293B` and text becoming `#F1F5F9`.

Typography

Role	Font	Weight	Size (Desktop)
Display/Hero Headline	<i>Playfair Display</i> or <i>Merriweather</i>	700	48–64px
Section Headline	<i>Inter</i>	700	28–36px
Article Card Title	<i>Inter</i>	600	18–22px
Body Copy	<i>Inter</i>	400	16–18px, 1.7 line-height
Metadata/Kicker	<i>JetBrains Mono</i>	400	11–12px, uppercase, tracked
UI Labels/Buttons	<i>Inter</i>	500–600	13–14px

The use of a monospaced font for metadata (dates, categories, signal scores) is a deliberate design choice that reinforces the technical, data-driven nature of the publication. It visually differentiates editorial metadata from editorial content.

Iconography & Visual Language

The ROMAS Insight label — the proprietary analysis badge — should be a distinct visual element: a small pill-shaped badge in `--color-accent-500` with white text reading “ROMAS INSIGHT.” This badge should appear on article cards, within article bodies, and in the audio player when the content includes proprietary commentary.

Signal scores (the 0–100 relevance/impact score from the SSOT) should be visualized as a small circular gauge or a colored numeric badge using the signal color tokens above. A score of 85+ gets `--color-signal-green`, 60–84 gets `--color-signal-amber`, and below 60 gets a neutral gray.

4.3 Page-by-Page Design Specification

The Homepage

The homepage is the most critical page and must serve three simultaneous goals: inform returning readers of today’s most important developments, orient new visitors to the

brand's value proposition, and convert both groups into subscribers.

Zone 1: Global Header (Sticky) A slim, sticky header (56px height) with a dark background (`--color-primary-900`). The ROMAS Brief wordmark sits on the left. The center contains five primary navigation links: *Today's Brief*, *Topics*, *Regions*, *Listen*, and *Archive*. The right side contains a search icon and a high-contrast "Subscribe Free" button in `--color-accent-500` . On mobile, the center links collapse into a hamburger menu.

Zone 2: The Edition Banner (Above the Fold) A slim, dismissible banner immediately below the header displaying the current edition: "**ROMAS Brief — Americas Edition | Wednesday, May 28, 2026**" with a small globe icon and a dropdown to switch to the EU or APAC edition. This directly addresses the three-edition re-rank requirement from the product spec and immediately signals to the reader that the content is personalized to their region.

Zone 3: The Daily Brief (Hero Module) This is the most important zone on the page and must be visually dominant. It uses an asymmetric two-column layout on desktop ($\frac{60}{40}$ split):

- **Left column (60%):** The single most important story of the day, rendered as a "Feature Card." This includes a high-quality image (16:9 ratio, minimum 800px wide), the category kicker in monospaced text, the headline in the display serif font (48px), a 2-3 sentence excerpt, the ROMAS Insight badge (if applicable), the signal score badge, and a "Read Brief" CTA link.
- **Right column (40%):** A "Quick Hits" panel titled "**Also Today**" in a slim, dark-background sidebar. This contains 4-5 article titles with their category kickers and timestamps, presented as a clean, scannable list with no images. Each item has a thin left-border in the category's accent color.

Zone 4: Inline Conversion Widget A full-width band in `--color-surface-50` with a centered, two-column layout. Left side: "**The brief your colleagues are already reading.**" with a subscriber count. Right side: a single email input field and a "Get the Brief" button. No modal, no pop-up. This is the only conversion interrupt on the page.

Zone 5: Topic Clusters Three horizontal sections, each dedicated to a major topic cluster. Each cluster has a section header (e.g., "**AI & Technology**"), a "View All" link, and a 3-column grid of Standard Cards. The three default clusters on the homepage are: *AI & Technology*, *Clinical Practice & Guidelines*, and *Regulatory & Reimbursement*. These map directly to the highest-traffic categories in the product spec.

Zone 6: The Audio Intelligence Module A visually distinct, dark-background section (--color-primary-700) titled “**Listen: ROMAS Audio Brief.**” This contains 2-3 audio cards, each showing the article title, duration, tier (Audio Brief / Daily Brief / Podcast), and an inline play button. A “Browse All Audio” CTA links to /listen . This module directly surfaces the audio-first value proposition that differentiates ROMAS Brief from The Imaging Wire.

Zone 7: The “Paper of the Week” Feature A full-width, magazine-style feature treatment for the most significant academic paper of the week. This uses a large, typographically rich layout with the paper title, journal name, key finding in a large pull-quote, and a “Read the Critique” CTA. This signals editorial depth and academic credibility.

Zone 8: The Global Pulse (Region Grid) A compact 4-column grid showing the top story from each of the 4 major regions (Americas, Europe, APAC, Global). Each card is minimal: region flag/icon, headline, and timestamp. This reinforces the global coverage positioning.

Zone 9: Footer A structured, 4-column footer with: (1) Brand column (logo, tagline, social links), (2) Content column (Topics, Regions, Audiences, Archive), (3) Company column (About, Advertise, Contact, Terms, Privacy), (4) Newsletter column (brief description of each edition + subscribe links). The footer background uses --color-primary-900 with white text.

The Article Page

The article page must prioritize a focused, distraction-free reading experience while providing rich contextual information.

Layout: A centered, single-column reading layout with a maximum content width of 720px, flanked by a sticky right-hand sidebar (280px) on desktop. The sidebar is hidden on mobile, with its content collapsed into an accordion below the article body.

Article Header: Category kicker (monospaced, colored by category), headline (display serif, 40–48px), a 1-sentence deck/subheadline (body font, 20px, gray), author/date metadata, estimated read time, and the signal score badge. The ROMAS Insight badge appears here if the article contains proprietary analysis.

Audio Player (Inline): Immediately below the article header, a compact audio player bar (full-width of the content column) showing the audio tier, duration, and play/pause/scrub controls. This is the primary audio entry point.

Body Copy: 16–18px Inter, 1.75 line-height, with generous paragraph spacing (1.5em). Block quotes are styled with a left border in `--color-accent-500`. Key terms or ROMAS-specific labels (e.g., “Practice Delta,” “FDA Brief”) are rendered as colored inline badges.

Right Sidebar (Sticky): Contains: (1) “Key Takeaways” — a 3-5 point bulleted summary of the article, (2) “Related Briefs” — 3 related article cards (title + timestamp only), (3) Inline newsletter signup widget.

Article Footer: A “References” section with academic-style numbered citations, a “Tags” section (category + region + audience), and a “Share” row with clean icon buttons.

Archive & Taxonomy Pages (Categories, Regions, Audiences, Content Types)

These pages function as specialized dashboards for readers who want to explore a specific domain.

Page Header: A large, typographically bold header with the taxonomy name (e.g., “**Artificial Intelligence**”), a 1-2 sentence description of what this category covers, and a subscriber count for that topic’s dedicated newsletter (if applicable).

Featured Article: The most recent or highest-signal article in this taxonomy is given a full-width Feature Card treatment at the top of the page.

Article Grid: A 3-column grid of Standard Cards below the featured article, with infinite scroll or a “Load More” button. A filter bar above the grid allows sorting by date or signal score.

The Listen Page

The Listen page is a unique differentiator for ROMAS Brief and should be designed to feel like a premium podcast app, not an afterthought.

Layout: A dark-background page (`--color-primary-900`) to signal the audio-first experience. A hero section shows the latest episode with a large play button, episode title, duration, and a waveform visualization.

Tier Navigation: Four horizontal tabs — *Audio Brief*, *Daily Brief*, *Podcast*, *Conference Brief* — allow users to filter by audio tier.

Episode Grid: A 2-column grid of audio cards, each showing the episode thumbnail, title, duration, tier badge, and a play button. Clicking a card opens an expanded player at the bottom of the page (a persistent mini-player bar).

RSS Feed Links: A clearly visible “Subscribe via RSS” section with icons for Apple Podcasts, Spotify, and a direct RSS feed link.

The Issue Archive Page

A clean, calendar-style or list-style archive of all past issues, grouped by month. Each issue entry shows the issue number, date, headline story, and a “Read Issue” CTA. This page reinforces the publication’s history and credibility.

4.4 Component Library

Component	Variants	Key Properties
ArticleCard	Feature, Standard, Quick Hit, Audio	image, title, excerpt, category, date, signalScore, romasInsight, audioUrl
InlineAudioPlayer	Compact (card), Full (article page), Mini (persistent footer)	src, title, duration, tier, isPlaying
SignalScoreBadge	Numeric (0-100), Colored by threshold	score, size
ROMAInsightBadge	Default, Compact	—
CategoryKicker	Default, Colored	category, color
ConversionWidget	Inline (between modules), Sidebar, Sticky Footer	headline, subheadline, placeholder, ctaLabel
EditionBanner	Americas, EU, APAC	currentEdition, onSwitch
SponsorFirewall	Leaderboard, Rectangle	sponsorName, imageUrl, targetUrl, label=“Sponsored”
RegionCard	Compact (grid)	region, topStory, flag
TopicCluster	3-column grid	topic, articles[], viewAllHref

4.5 Responsive Design Specification

Breakpoint	Layout Changes
320px (Mobile S)	Single column. Hero becomes stacked (image above, Quick Hits below). Sidebar hidden. Nav collapses to hamburger.
390px (Mobile M)	Same as 320px. Article cards stack vertically.
768px (Tablet)	Two-column grid for article cards. Sidebar appears as a collapsible accordion below article body.
1024px (Desktop S)	Full three-column grid. Sticky sidebar appears on article pages.
1440px (Desktop L)	Maximum content width (1280px) centered. Generous whitespace margins.

4.6 Accessibility Requirements (WCAG 2.2 AA)

All color combinations must meet a minimum contrast ratio of 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text. The `--color-accent-500` (`#0EA5E9`) on white (`#FFFFFF`) achieves a ratio of 3.2:1 — acceptable for large text (headlines) but not for body copy. For body copy links, use `--color-accent-700` (`#0369A1`) which achieves 5.9:1 on white.

All interactive elements must have visible focus states (a 2px `--color-accent-500` outline with a 2px offset). The audio player must be fully keyboard-navigable. All images must have descriptive `alt` attributes. The edition switcher must be accessible via keyboard and announce the selected edition to screen readers.

4.7 Implementation Roadmap

The following is a sequenced, 4-sprint implementation plan to bring the ROMAS Brief design proposal to life on the existing Vercel deployment.

Sprint	Duration	Deliverables
Sprint 1: Design System	1 week	Tailwind config update (new color tokens, typography scale), global CSS variables, dark mode toggle
Sprint 2: Component Library	1 week	ArticleCard (3 variants), InlineAudioPlayer (3 variants), SignalScoreBadge, ROMAInsightBadge, ConversionWidget, EditionBanner
Sprint 3: Homepage & Article Page	1 week	Full homepage restructure (8 modules), article page redesign (reading column + sticky sidebar)
Sprint 4: Archive Pages & Polish	1 week	Category/Region/Audience/Content-Type pages, Listen page redesign, Issue Archive, WCAG audit, mobile QA

4.8 Competitive Differentiation Summary

Feature	The Imaging Wire	ROMAS Brief (Proposed)
Editorial Hierarchy	Chronological feed	Curated 8-module dashboard
Visual Language	Generic corporate blue/white	Premium slate/navy + clinical accent
Typography	Generic sans-serif	Display serif headlines + mono metadata
Audio Integration	None	Prominent Audio Intelligence module + persistent mini-player
Personalization	None	3-edition re-rank (Americas/EU/APAC)
Signal Intelligence	None	Signal score badges on every article
Conversion Strategy	Aggressive banner + modal	Integrated inline widgets, no modal
Dark Mode	Not available	Full dark mode support
Accessibility	Unknown	WCAG 2.2 AA certified
Specialty Focus	Broad radiology	Radiation oncology physics only

This report was prepared by Manus AI on May 28, 2026, based on direct observation of The Imaging Wire homepage, analysis of B2B media design benchmarks, and the ROMAS Brief product specification (SSOT v3.1).